



Netflix to host The Witcher anime

Netflix is working on an anime film named 'The Witcher: Nightmare of the Wolf' set in the Henry-Cavill Witcher universe. <https://digit.in/feb20-59>



BOP in Fortnite

Epic Games teased the next crossover event in Fortnite and it seems it will be Birds of Prey-themed. <https://digit.in/feb20-60>

Jebaited!

AMD's recent bait-and-switch hasn't gone down well with everyone

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emember when AMD unveiled the first RDNA graphics cards? The card was shown to be very

competitive with NVIDIA's new Super cards in terms of performance and price so it was natural for NVIDIA to drop their prices in order to become the better option. In a surprise move, AMD turned things around at the last moment by unveiling the actual price to be much lower than what they'd initially shown and also lower than what NVIDIA's new reduced prices. AMD says they had it planned that way all along and they'd just "jebaited" NVIDIA into dropping their prices conservatively. NVIDIA, faced with supposedly lower sales for the new Super series, wasn't going to drop prices for the same products twice in a short time period so AMD got away with making the competition blink first. Great move for the consumer as they get better performing cards at lower prices at the end of the day. Yay!

Whether this was a brilliant Machiavellian business move or a simple price restructuring, we'll never know, but it seems that NVIDIA's Super cards are still gaining market share as per Steam's latest hardware survey. Also, there's the fact that NVIDIA has a lot more GPUs selling at diverse price points compared to AMD. Steam is only a fraction of the actual market share, the latest JPR report for Q3-2019 shows that AMD in fact lost around 5 percent market share to NVIDIA.

The trick might have worked out for AMD because they decided to pull another one with the launch of their new RX 5600 XT. The chronology of events worked out in more or less the same fashion. AMD announced the card at CES 2020, NVIDIA dropped the price for the RTX 2060 as expected and on launch day AMD didn't drop the price. Instead, they issued a vBIOS update to boost the performance of the RX 5600 XT by 10 per cent. Jebaited, yet again!

This is where the problems begin...

Prior to the embargo lift, AMD had disseminated vBIOS updates which drastically altered the performance of the RX 5600 XT. This was not a uniform upgrade in performance as the



RX 5600 XT is only available via partner boards and not all of them have the right design or even the proper hardware to make the most of the newly issued vBIOS update. As a result, you now have a multitude of RX 5600 XT graphics cards with each performing differently. The new vBIOS update increases the board power by about 10W, the GPU clocks and the memory clock speed from 12 Gbps to 14 Gbps. Again, these numbers vary from card to card.

In an episode of the MSI Insider podcast, the folks over at MSI mentioned that the memory chips provided by AMD to partners are only validated to run at 12 Gbps so the cards are also

tested to run at the same and running those cards at 14 Gbps cannot be guaranteed. Moreover, the initial batch of cards entering the market DO NOT have the vBIOS update. Which means it'll be up to the consumer to perform the vBIOS update. If you happen to read the Warranty Terms of some of the manufacturers, then they clearly mention that the manufacturer "assumes no responsibility for any damages caused by improper operations of downloading or updating the vBIOS." Essentially, you cannot claim warranty for the card if you happen to brick it during the update process. Check the warranty terms of your manufacturer before even considering purchasing an RX 5600 XT. Yay!

After the initial batch, the cards that enter the market about 2-3 weeks later should be flashed with the new vBIOS from the factory. Certain manufacturers have updated their website with information about which cards have the old BIOS.

Globally, AMD released BIOS upgrades a couple of days prior to the embargo lifting but they seemed to have forgotten about disseminating the BIOS upgrades to all reviewers. We were one of the unlucky ones to have only gotten wind of the massive performance difference about

2.5 hours prior to the embargo lift and we still had to wait to get the new vBIOS once the official version was released by the manufacturer on their website. Which meant that the graphics card that we had benchmarked was a hypothetical one that none of you would have ever seen in the market. Obviously, we couldn't publish a review for an imaginary device and we had to re-run the tests to get proper numbers indicative of the actual SKU. While irritating the press and reviewers around the world might have been easy to overlook, giving out oddly configured graphics cards to paying customers is certainly not good. 🚩